WIKIPEDIA
The Free Encyclopedia

Senegalia senegal

Senegalia senegal (also known as *Acacia senegal*) is a small thorny deciduous tree from the genus *Senegalia*, which is known by several common names, including **gum acacia**, **gum arabic tree**, **Sudan gum** and **Sudan gum arabic**. In parts of India, it is known as **Kher** or **Khor**.[2] It is native to semi-desert regions of Sub-Saharan Africa, as well as Oman, Pakistan, and west coastal India. It grows to a height of 5–12 metres (16-40'), with a trunk up to 30 cm (1') in diameter.[3] *Sudan* is the source of the world's highest quality gum arabic, known locally as **hashab gum** in contrast to the related, but inferior, gum arabic from Red acacia or talah gum.[4]

Senegalia senegal	
Scientific classification	
Kingdom:	Plantae
Clade:	Tracheophytes
Clade:	Angiosperms
Clade:	Eudicots
Clade:	Rosids
Order:	Fabales
Family:	Fabaceae
Subfamily:	Caesalpinioideae
Clade:	Mimosoid clade
Genus:	*Senegalia*
Species:	***S. senegal***
Binomial name	
Senegalia senegal (L.) Britton	
Synonyms[1]	
▪ *Acacia circummarginata* Chiov.	

Uses

Gum arabic

The tree is of great economic importance for the gum arabic it produces which is used as a food additive, in crafts, and as a cosmetic. The gum is drained from cuts in the bark, and an individual tree will yield 200 to 300 grams (7 to 10 oz). Eighty percent of the world's gum arabic is produced in Sudan.[5] The Chauhatan area of Barmer district in Rajasthan is also famous for gum production, this is called कुम्मट[6] (Kummat) in local language there.

Forage

New foliage is very useful as forage.[7] Leaves and pods of *S. senegal* are browsed by domestic and wild ruminants.[8]

Agriculture

Like other legume species, *S. senegal* fixes nitrogen within *Rhizobia* or nitrogen-fixing bacteria living in root nodules.[4] This nitrogen fixation enriches the poor soils where it is grown, allowing for the rotation of other crops in naturally nutrient-poor regions.

Traditional uses

It has been reportedly used for its astringent properties, to treat bleeding, bronchitis, cough, diarrhea, dysentery, catarrh, gonorrhea, leprosy, typhoid fever and upper respiratory tract infections.[7][9]

Rope

Roots near the surface of the ground are quite useful in making all kinds of very strong ropes and cords. The tree bark is also used to make rope.[7]

Wood

The wood of *S. senegal* can be used to make handles for tools, and parts for weaving looms.[7] It is also valued as firewood and can be used to produce charcoal.[8]

Chemistry

S. senegal contains hentriacontane, a solid, long-chain alkane hydrocarbon. The leaf also contains the psychoactive alkaloid dimethyltryptamine.[10]

- *Acacia cufodontii* Chiov.
- *Acacia glaucophylla* *sensu* Brenan
- *Acacia kinionge* *sensu* Brenan
- *Acacia oxyosprion* Chiov.
- *Acacia rupestris* Boiss.
- *Acacia senegal* (L.) Willd.
- *Acacia senegal* subsp. *modesta* (Wall.) Roberty
- *Acacia senegal* subsp. *senegalensis* Roberty
- *Acacia somalensis* *sensu* Brenan
- *Acacia* sp. 1 F. White
- *Acacia spinosa* Marloth & Engl.
- *Acacia thomasii* *sensu* Brenan
- *Acacia volkii* Suess.
- *Mimosa senegal* L.

Senegalia senegal

A Gum acacia tree photographed at Taljai Hills, Pune

Senegalia Senegal (Kummat) tree in Jodhpur, Thadiya village

Senegalia senegal

See also

- List of Acacia species known to contain psychoactive alkaloids

- List of psychoactive plants

References

1. "Acacia senegal (L.) Willd. — the Plant List" (http://www.theplantlist.org/tpl1.1/record/ild-596).
2. Pervez, Amjad; Ahmad, Syed Muzaffar; Lathiya, Shaher Bano; Khadijah, Erum (2009). "Food Habits of the Indian Crested Porcupine, Hystrix indica in Sindh, Pakistan". *Pakistan Journal of Zoology*. **41** (4): 321. ISSN 0030-9923 (https://www.worldcat.org/issn/0030-9923). ProQuest 992958322 (https://search.proquest.com/docview/992958322).
3. World Agroforestry Centre (http://www.worldagroforestrycentre.org/SEA/Products/AFDbases/AF/asp/SpeciesInfo.asp?SpID=108) Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20070515192259/http://www.worldagroforestrycentre.org/SEA/Products/AFDbases/AF/asp/SpeciesInfo.asp?SpID=108) 2007-05-15 at the Wayback Machine
4. Suliman, Mohamed Osman (2011). *The Darfur Conflict : Geography or Institutions*. New York: Routledge. ISBN 978-0-415-88598-0.
5. "Gum arabic in Sudan: production and socio-economic aspects, United Nations Food & Agricultural Organisation" (http://www.fao.org/docrep/x5402e/x5402e12.htm)
6. "हिंदी खबर, Latest News in Hindi, हिंदी समाचार, ताजा खबर" (https://www.patrika.com/jodhpur-news/kair-sangri-of-marwar-are-costlier-than-dry-fruits-2366705/). *Patrika* (in Hindi). Retrieved 7 December 2020.
7. "Acacia senegal" (http://www.hort.purdue.edu/newcrop/duke_energy/Acacia_senegal.html). *www.hort.purdue.edu*. Retrieved 2017-08-03.
8. Heuzé V., Thiollet H., Tran G., Hassoun P., Bastianelli D., Lebas F., 2016. Gum arabic tree (*Acacia senegal*). Feedipedia, a programme by INRA, CIRAD, AFZ and FAO. https://www.feedipedia.org/node/342
9. Wren, R.C. (1923). *Potter's Cylopedia of Botanical Drugs and Preparations*. London: Potter & Clark. p. 2.
10. Khalil, S.K.W. & Elkheir, Y.M. 1975. “Dimethyltryptamine from the leafs of certain *Acacia* species of Northern Sudan.” Lloydia 38(3):176-177.

External links

- *Senegalia senegal* Photos (Google Images) (https://images.google.com/images?svnum=10&um=1&hl=en&ie=ISO-8859-1&oe=ISO-8859-1&gbv=1&q=%22Acacia+senegal%22+&btnG=Search+Images)
- *Acacia senegal* (http://www.westafricanplants.senckenberg.de/root/index.php?page_id=13&preview=true&searchTextMenue=Acacia+senegal&search=Wikitemplate) in West African plants – A Photo Guide. (http://www.westafricanplants.senckenberg.de/)
- PROTA on Pl@ntUse (http://uses.plantnet-project.org/en/Acacia_senegal_(PROTA))

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Senegalia_senegal&oldid=1218997576"

-